

Support for IT Project Management

LABORATORY

Utilizing Software to Communicate Within a Group

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Arseni Martysiuk - Nicola Secci

Functional Specifications

Defining user needs and prioritized technical requirements

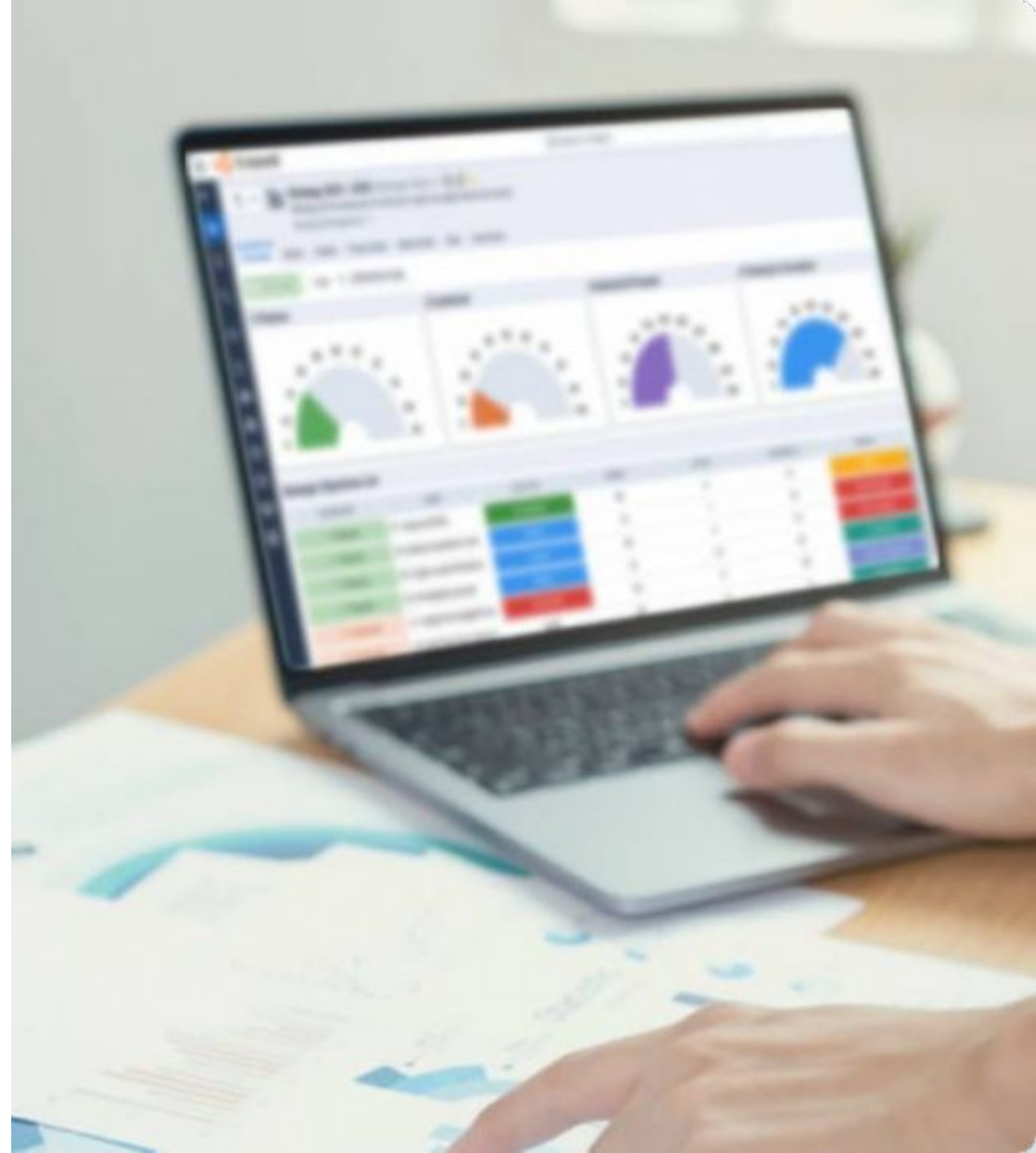
User Needs: PM Perspective

Centralized Knowledge: As a Project Manager, I require a single source of truth for all project discussions.

Transparency: Ability to monitor work progress without intrusive status meetings.

Contextual Search: Rapid retrieval of past decisions and technical specifications.

Security & Compliance: Ensuring intellectual property remains within organizational boundaries.



Core Communication Channels



Persistent Messaging

Input: Rich text, emojis, snippets.

Output: Time-stamped, searchable message feed.

Purpose: Real-time and asynchronous team synchronization.

MUST HAVE



Threaded Replies

Input: Specific message reference.

Output: Nested conversation branch.

Purpose: Maintaining context and reducing main-channel noise.

MUST HAVE



Instant Huddles

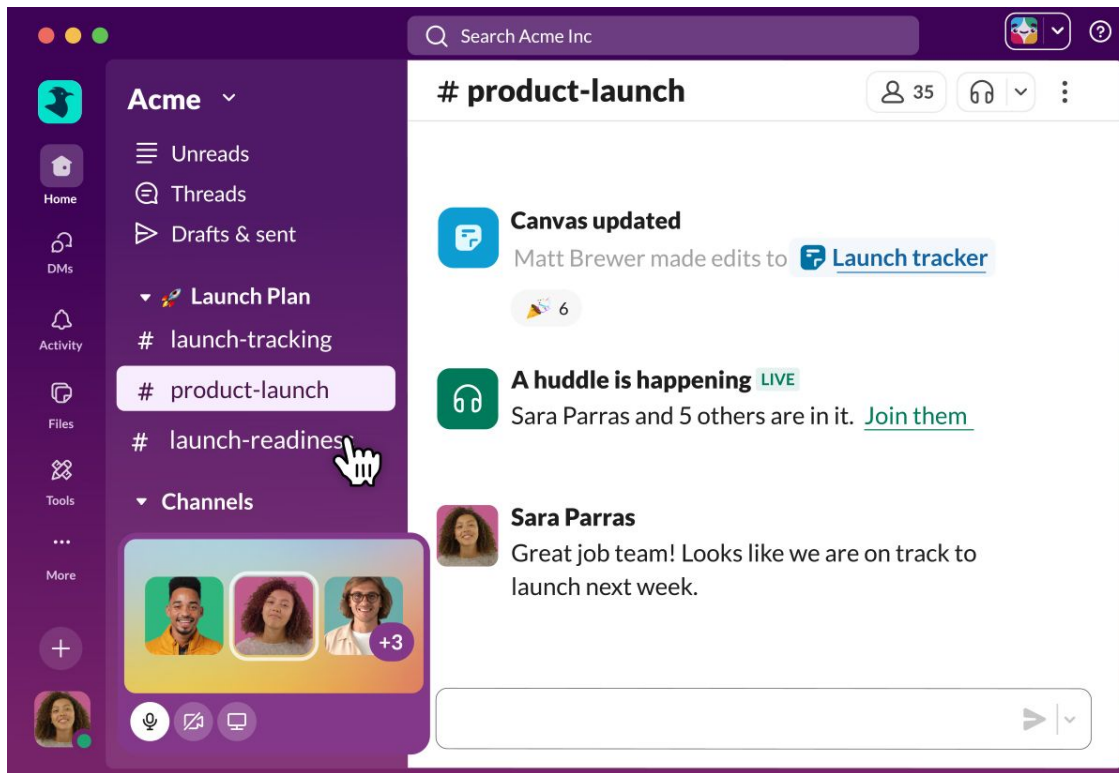
Input: Audio/Video stream initiate.

Output: Low-latency conference session.

Purpose: Resolving complex issues through quick ad-hoc calls.

SHOULD HAVE

Workflow & Context Management



Universal Search

Input: Keywords, filters (sender, date).

Output: Relevance-ranked results across all history.

MoSCoW: MUST HAVE

App Integrations

Input: External Webhooks (Jira, GitHub).

Output: Automated alerts/actions in channel.

MoSCoW: COULD HAVE

Functionality Specification Table

Functionality Name	Input Data	Output Info	Strategic Purpose	MoSCoW
User Identity Management	LDAP/SSO Credentials	Permission-based Access	Security and Role governance	MUST
File Version Control	Cloud Storage Link	Preview & Direct Edit	Preventing data silos	SHOULD
Notification Profiles	Schedule/Keyword rules	Mobile/Desktop alerts	Work-life balance / Focus time	SHOULD
Interactive Canvases	Free-form text/media	Collaborative doc	Permanent project documentation	COULD

Market & Price Analysis

Benchmarking industry solutions and cost-efficiency

| Top Communication Solutions

Program Name	Type	Producer	Price (Monthly/User)
Slack	Web / Desktop	Salesforce	\$0 (Free) \$7.25 (Pro)
Microsoft Teams	Web / Desktop	Microsoft	Included in M365 (\$4.00+)
Discord	Web / Desktop	Discord Inc.	\$0 (Free) \$9.99 (Nitro)
Rocket.Chat	Self-hosted / Cloud	Rocket.Chat	\$0 (Community) \$4.00 (Pro)

Cost Structure & Tiers

Free Tiers

Limited message history (e.g., 90 days in Slack) and reduced storage space. Best for evaluation or small volunteer groups.

Enterprise Pricing

Includes SAML-based SSO, compliance exports, and 99.99% uptime guarantees. Essential for regulated industries.

Note: Prices reflect annual billing. Monthly billing incurs a 15-20% surcharge.

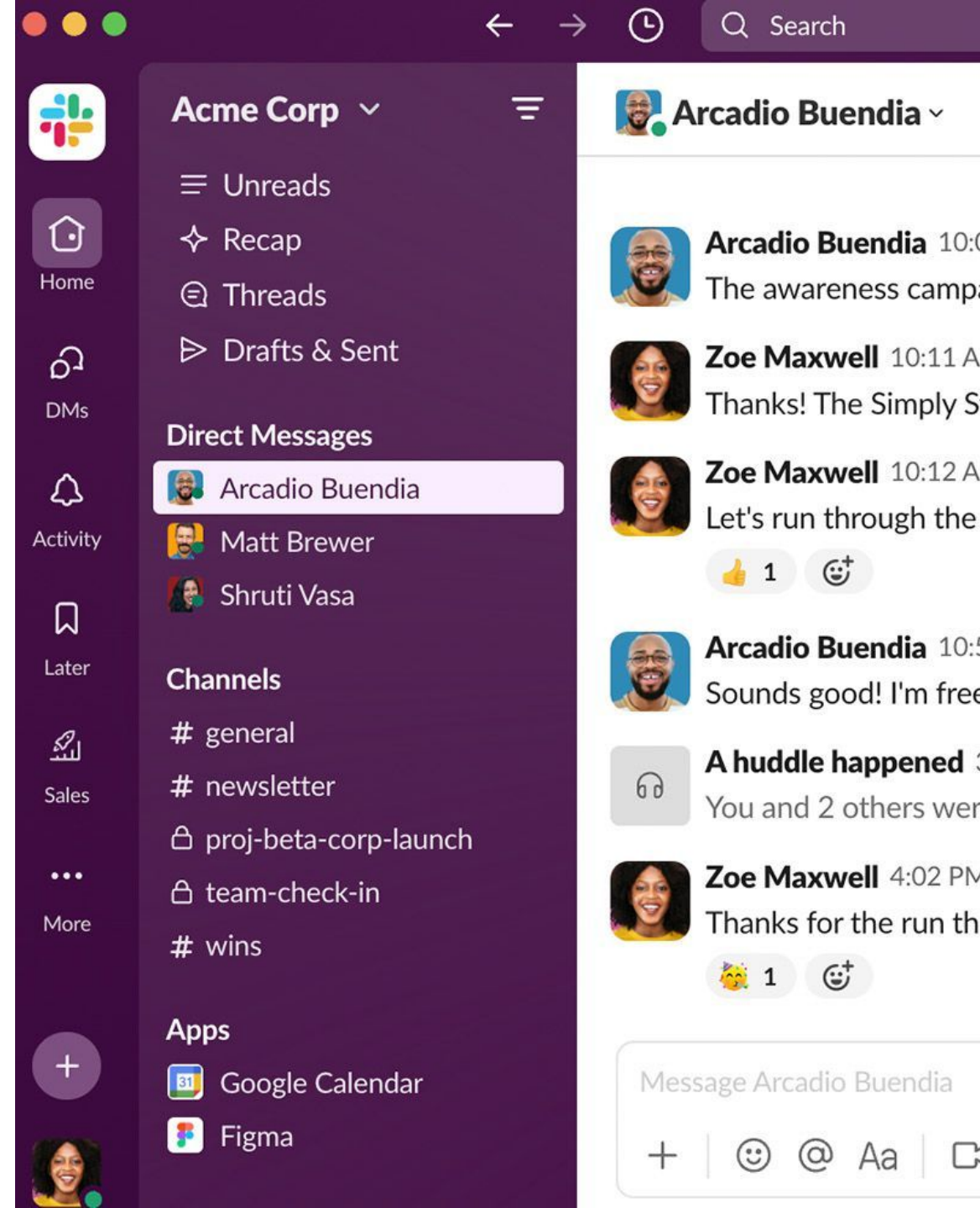
Selection: Why Slack?

Unmatched Ecosystem: Over 2,600 apps in the directory allow for seamless PM workflow integration.

Superior UX: Lower cognitive load leads to higher team adoption and less "shadow IT."

Powerful Search: The "search-first" architecture ensures legacy knowledge is never lost.

Mobile Parity: Full functionality on mobile ensures distributed teams stay connected.



Practical Exercise

| Step-by-Step Implementation

Setup Phase

- Visit **slack.com** and select "Create a Workspace."
- Login via Google or Email.
- Choose the Slack Limited plan.

Guided Task

Goal: Structure a project channel.

1. Create #project-alpha-dev channel.
2. Add a **Channel Canvas** with project goals.
3. Set a channel **Topic** and **Description**.
4. Post a message and start a **thread** to simulate a bug report.
5. Use Workflow Builder to create a "Daily Standup" reminder that posts every morning at 9:00 AM.